



A painting entitled *The Victor* by Russian war artist Vasily Vereshchagin (1842–1904) depicts Turks celebrating a victory during the Russo–Turkish War. Hostilities between Russia and the Ottoman Empire were long-running and the two had gone to battle many times over the previous two centuries.

THE RIFT BETWEEN THE OTTOMAN EMPIRE AND ITS SUBJECTS IN

Bosnia and Herzegovina grew wider as **Christian** inhabitants of the two territories **rebelled** against Ottoman rule, requesting aid from neighboring **Serbia**, which had a much higher degree of autonomy. Buoyed by Russian promises of support and inspired by the nationalism sweeping through the region, Serbia too declared war on the Ottoman Empire on June 30, 1876; **Montenegro** followed suit the next day, leading the weakening empire into another destabilizing conflict. Montenegro was initially successful, with a victory in Herzegovina, but Russian support in Serbia did not materialize and the Turks won the battle of Aleksinac on August 9, 1876. This forced the Serbs to appeal to other nations for help.

In other parts of the Ottoman world, **Egypt** continued to make incursions into **Ethiopia**, leading its king, Yohannes IV (see 1872), to declare war on the Egyptians. The conflict arose because Ismail Pasha (1830–95), the khedive (viceroy) of Egypt, wanted to put settlements on strategic points along the **Red Sea** coastline in Ethiopian territory (present-day Eritrea). By 1875 Egypt had succeeded in occupying many coastal towns, as well as the inland city of Harar. The fighting lasted until 1877, by which time Ethiopia had managed to defeat two Egyptian campaigns.

ANGER AND UNREST HAD BEEN growing among American Indians in the US, many of whom had been forced off their land. This issue often resulted in armed conflict with US troops. One of the most infamous confrontations was the **Battle of Little Bighorn** where, on June 25, Lieutenant Colonel George A. Custer (1839–76)

“THE NATION THAT SECURES CONTROL OF THE AIR WILL ULTIMATELY CONTROL THE WORLD.”

Alexander Graham Bell, Scottish inventor

and his men were killed by a coalition of Eastern **Sioux** and Northern **Cheyenne** Indians. Around the same time, US forces were fighting the **Apache** people,

who lived near the border with Mexico. They too were angered by attempts to move them onto a reservation, and attacked white settlements. This conflict continued for another decade until their leader, **Geronimo** (1829–1909), surrendered in 1886.

Elsewhere in the US, a Scottish-born inventor named **Alexander Graham Bell** (1847–1922) patented his device for “transmitting vocal or other sounds telegraphically”—the **first telephone**. This development would change forever the way the world communicated.

In Mexico, former soldier **Porfirio Díaz** (see panel, right) tried to launch a revolt against president Sebastián Lerdo de Tejada. His attempt in early 1876 failed and he fled to the US. He returned in November and defeated the government's troops. In May 1877 he was elected president and controlled Mexico for decades.

Explorer **Henry Morton Stanley** (1841–1904), meanwhile, was trying to follow the uncharted Lualaba River in the **Congo** to



PORFIRIO DÍAZ
(1830–1915)

Mexican general, politician, and president, Porfirio Díaz was of mixed European and indigenous descent. From a humble background, he made a name for himself in the military. After he was elected president, he shored up his support and created a political machine that kept him in power and the opposition divided and suppressed, leaving him to control politics in Mexico for more than 30 years.

IN CHINA, FAMINE SPREAD

through the northern provinces. A drought the previous year affecting the **Yellow River**—a vital source of water—was compounded by a lack of rain in 1877 and the arrival of locusts. When the rains returned toward the end of the following year, some 9 to 13 million people had died in a region of 108 million.

In South Africa, the discovery of **gold** (see 1871) had exacerbated tensions between the Boer settlers and the British, who by this point governed much of the country. By 1877 the British managed to **annex the Transvaal**. However, the Afrikaners rebelled against this move and regained their independence a few years later (see 1881).

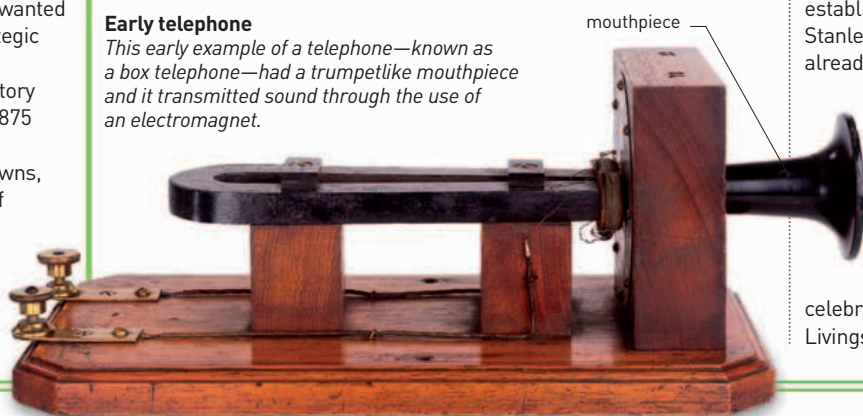


Famine in China

An illustration in a French magazine shows the state of poverty during the famine years in China, when millions died in the northern region.

Early telephone

This early example of a telephone—known as a **box telephone**—had a trumpetlike mouthpiece and it transmitted sound through the use of an electromagnet.



establish which river it joined. Stanley's African exploits were already famous; he had been previously sent by a US newspaper to find fellow explorer David Livingstone (see 1855) and in 1871, on the shores of Lake Tanganyika, he had supposedly uttered the celebrated words, “Doctor Livingstone, I presume?”

Revolts in Balkans over Ottoman rule

March 3 French composer Georges Bizet's (1838–75) opera *Carmen* debuts in Paris

September 7 Egyptian invasion of Ethiopia defeated

Asia's first stock exchange opens in present-day Mumbai

March 7 Scottish inventor Alexander Graham Bell (1847–1922) patents telephone in US

April 16 Bulgarian uprising in Ottoman Empire; leads to Bulgaria's independence in 1878

May 1 Queen Victoria takes title Empress of India

June 25–26 Battle of Little Bighorn: American Indian alliance wipes out US force of 250 soldiers

June The Adventures of Tom Sawyer by US author Mark Twain published

Japan forces Korea to sign unequal treaty, opening ports to Japanese ships

July Serbia and Montenegro declare war on their Ottoman rulers

August 31 Murat V of Ottoman Empire succeeded by Abdul Hamid II

November 28 Start of dictatorship by Porfirio Díaz in Mexico

October 31 Cyclone kills 200,000 in India

Russia declares war on Ottoman Empire (to 1878) over Ottoman control of Serbia

May 6 Chief Crazy Horse (c. 1840–1877) of Oglala Sioux surrenders to US army; later killed in custody

Great North China Famine (until 1879)

Romania declares independence from Ottoman Empire